

JETRO Regional and Analysis Report New Arrival Notice (July 23, 2026 Issue)

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We bring you the latest information on regional and analysis reports conducted by JETRO with its unique perspective on political and economic trends in major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find these reports useful.

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[Special Feature] Turbulent Middle East Situation: Impact and Outlook for Middle Eastern Countries <Additional Articles>

In response to the destabilization of the Middle East situation, the business environment surrounding companies operating in the region is undergoing significant changes. This special feature examines the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region, tracking recent developments in logistics, trade, and various industries, as well as corporate initiatives, while also investigating and analyzing government responses and economic policies according to the situation. Through these efforts, we comprehensively clarify geopolitical risks and new market opportunities in the MENA region, presenting a wide range of information to support Japanese companies' future Middle East business ventures.

<Additional Articles>

◇UAE's Resilience Questioned as Middle East's Logistics Hub

◇Saudi Arabia's Strained Logistics Network

[Asia/Vietnam] Local Companies' Perspectives on Vietnam's E-Commerce Market (3): Bao Chau's Regional Penetration Strategy

Vietnam's population exceeded 100 million in 2023, attracting attention as a consumption market. However, due to disparities in purchasing power and constraints in distribution networks, Japanese companies' business expansion and product sales are primarily limited to urban areas, with penetration into regional areas proving particularly challenging.

This article features an interview with Nguyen Thi Thu, CEO of Bao Chau Cosmetic, a local company serving as an import distributor for Japanese cosmetics, as a successful example of marketing targeting all of Vietnam.

<Reprinted> Local Companies' Perspectives on Vietnam's E-Commerce Market

(1) Cool Mate's Marketing Strategy

(2) OME Cosmetic's Strategy

[United States] Energy Modernization in Maine: Multi-Layered Governance Aimed at Local Production and Consumption

Maine, located in the northeastern United States, is blessed with renewable energy resources. The northern part of the state is particularly suitable for onshore wind power and possesses abundant forest biomass resources. However, weak transmission grid infrastructure, including capacity shortages, had constrained development. Additionally, limited transportation capacity of gas and oil pipelines created problems in consistently meeting winter heating demand. In response to these circumstances, Maine has been pursuing an "electrification policy" and "transmission grid modernization" to replace heating and transportation with electricity for approximately the past 20 years. Since Governor Janet Mills (Democratic Party) took office in January 2019, Maine has established "multi-layered governance" in which state government, public commissions, and municipalities share roles while operating policies, accelerating efforts toward electrification and renewable energy adoption.

[Asia/India] Gujarat State Announces "Industrial Policy 2026"

The Gujarat (GJ) State Government in western India announced the "Advanced Gujarat Industrial Policy 2026" on June 15, with attendance by Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel and Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghvi. This policy provides flexible investment incentives, including capital subsidies for fixed capital investments, to companies across a wide range of industries and sizes, while incorporating recruitment of research and development bases, industrial and environmental infrastructure development, regional development, and human resource development into a comprehensive industrial policy. Targeting a five-year period beginning June 1, 2026, this policy adopts the vision of "Gujarat's development supporting India's development" and aims to achieve an economic scale of 3.5 trillion dollars by 2047.

[Asia/Malaysia] Furuno Electric's Business Expansion and Localization Strategy in Malaysia

Hyogo Prefecture is home to numerous companies with world-leading technologies and companies with premier domestic distribution networks. This article introduces the initiatives of Furuno Electric, a Hyogo-based company expanding its business operations in Malaysia through unique strategies, as Malaysia continues stable growth among ASEAN nations.

[Middle East/Saudi Arabia] City Building at the Riyadh Expo: The Forefront of Urban Development Spreading Across Northern Riyadh

Saudi Arabia is currently promoting development to host the Riyadh Expo (EXPO 2030) in the capital Riyadh from October 1, 2030, to March 31, 2031, over approximately six months. This expo is positioned as a pillar of the country's long-term national strategy "Vision 2030" and is garnering attention as a national project that will accelerate urban development and industrial upgrading. This article provides an overview of the background to the decision regarding this expo, expected to be the largest in scale in the Middle East

region, as well as the development status as of late June 2026.

[Europe/Ukraine] Ukraine's Largest Drugstore Chain Expands Business Through Aggressive Investment

EVA, Ukraine's largest drugstore chain, is...